



Episode 92: The Purim Meal on a Friday
by Morris Arking

The Mequbalim always eat the festive Purim meal in the morning regardless of what day of the week Purim is observed. But when Purim falls on Friday there are Posqim who strongly recommend eating the meal in the morning in order to have an appetite for the Shabbat meal on Friday night. If one could not eat the meal before midday then they should eat the meal in the afternoon before the beginning of the tenth hour. And if one did not eat the meal by then, they still must eat it in the late afternoon as long as they stop eating and drinking before sunset.

Another option that is found in several Rishonim and Aharonim for the Purim meal on Friday is Poress Mapah UM'qadesh. Here is how it is done:

- 1) Begin the meal an hour or so before sunset. Eat meat and drink wine in honor of Purim during the first part of the meal. Bread is not a requirement during the first part of the meal, but if you do begin with bread then you do not repeat HaMossi after Qiddush.
- 2) Prior to sunset light the candles, cover the bread and recite Qiddush. You can not continue to eat and drink after sunset until you recite Qiddush. Omit the blessing of Bore' P'ri HaGefen in Qiddush since you already recited HaGefen when you drank wine at the beginning of the meal.
- 3) After Qiddush you must eat two ounces, or at least one ounce of bread in honor of Shabbat.
- 4) After the meal recite Birkat HaMazon. If you had at least one ounce of bread before Qiddush some authorities instruct you to add 'Al HaNissim (and R'sseh V'Hahalissenu) in Birkat HaMazon. But according to H 'Obadyah Yosef you only add R'sseh V'Hahalissenu even if you had an ounce or more of bread before Qiddush.
- 5) After the meal, when you are no longer intoxicated recite 'Arbit of Shabbat

According to H Ya'aqob Dweck (Aleppo- d 1919) the Purim meal should be served at midday when Purim falls on Friday. He did not mention the option of Poress Mapah at all. Furthermore, Poress Mapah UM'qadesh was not customary in our community when Purim fell on Friday. However it is a viable option Halakhically for those that are comfortable with all of the details that are required to do it properly.